

Westhampton, MA Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Westhampton Elementary School Library
(In conjunction with WES School Committee and Admin)

March 24, 2026

Meeting called to order at 7:47pm

In attendance - Jeremy Durrin, Jennifer Milikowsky, Tad Weiss, Scott Stanton (taking notes), Jon Albitz, Maureen Dempsey

Also in attendance: Susan Bronstein (Select Board), Vito Perrone (Superintendent), Dawn Scaparotti (Central Office Business Manager), Andrea McGrath (WES Principal), WES School Committee members

Motion to approve minutes from 3/18/26 by Durrin, seconded by Dempsey. **Approved 6-0-0**

Selectboard signed a warrant to pay \$40k for a student out midyear. This is most likely not the full year tuition cost. This was not accounted for in the FY26 budget, but the Central Office thinks they can cover it with Extraordinary Relief money. Next year, that student will be going to HRHS so additional funding will not be needed in FY27.

Milikowsky and Bronstein presented the Informational Session slides that will be presented tomorrow, 3/25, during the first Informational Session, to the WES Committee.

School Committee input on the Option 3 slide (Austerity Budget) to add information about how this will affect school choice if WES becomes less desirable from these cuts and the long term, compounding negative financial impacts.

Albitz brought back up the conversation about changing the insurance contribution split from the current 75/25 split. The Selectboard has decided that that will only be considered if the override fails because it compounds on existing increases to insurance costs.

Conversation about the idea of moving from the Hampshire County Trust to another group like GIC, but it was determined that this would not provide [at this time] significant savings based on detailed analysis by the Selectboard and Treasurer.

Motion to adjourn at 8:52pm by Milikowsky, seconded by Albitz. **Approved 6-0-0**

At the WES School Committee prior to FinCom meeting:

School committee voted to approve the FY27 WES budget at \$2,513,086. The portion charged to town would be \$2,193,873 – which is level funded from FY26.